Sii Khaw: Marketing Plan for an Eco-Friendly Tea Scrub

Revised portfolio edition · Prepared by Poowadol Kongkam

Project	Details
Course	1202218 Economics of Financial Market and Institution, Mae Fah Luang University
Instructor	Dr. Parinyakorn Paengsri
Team	15 students from Economics, Business Administration, and Tourism Business and Events
My role	Analysis sub-team: market situation analysis (Section 2)
Year	2025

This is a revised, condensed edition of our group report, prepared by Poowadol Kongkam for portfolio use. Section 2, marked "My contribution", is the part I worked on with the analysis sub-team.

1. Executive Summary

Sii Khaw is a tea-based body scrub for health- and eco-conscious consumers, launched online first and priced from 249 THB. The name comes from a Thai word meaning "whiteness", and the brand is built around its slogan: *"Glow Naturally, Scrub Gently."*

The product. The formula blends finely ground tea leaves, honey, natural sugar, mineral salts and nourishing oils. It removes dead skin cells and unclogs pores without the irritation of harsh shells or plastic microbeads, and it hydrates the skin at the same time. Packaging is 100% recyclable, and ingredients are sourced in Chiang Rai.

The opportunity. Demand for clean, natural and sustainable skincare is growing, especially among Millennials and Gen Z. Existing scrubs are either affordable but harsh (St. Ives), natural but expensive (Herbivore Botanicals), or fun but messy (Frank Body). Sii Khaw aims to be gentle, natural and fairly priced.

The plan.

- **Position** Sii Khaw as an affordable, spa-like natural scrub, using a "Purple Cow" strategy to stand out.
- **Price** with value-based tiers: 249 THB single pack, 649 THB three-pack, 749 THB deluxe kit.
- **Sell** online first (own website, Shopee, Lazada), then through eco-conscious boutiques and salons.
- **Promote** through Instagram, TikTok and Facebook, eco-conscious influencers, and educational content.
- **Launch** in four phases over two years, from brand foundation to regional expansion.

2. Market Situation Analysis *(My contribution)*

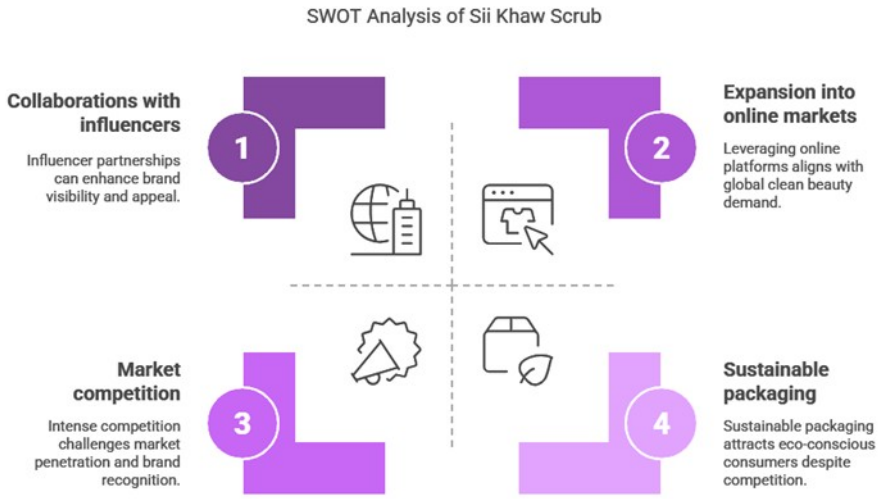
The market favors Sii Khaw: consumers are moving toward natural, sustainable skincare, and no major competitor combines gentle exfoliation, natural ingredients and an accessible price. The main risks are strong competition and the cost of building a new brand. We used five frameworks to reach this view.

2.1 PESTLE Analysis

Factor	Key finding	What it means for Sii Khaw
Political	Many countries ban plastic microbeads; Thailand promotes sustainable agriculture.	Natural exfoliants are favored by regulation, and local sourcing is supported.
Economic	Self-care spending stays resilient in downturns; the middle class is growing in emerging markets.	Room for a premium-quality but affordable brand; exchange rates affect imported input costs.
Social	Millennials and Gen Z prefer clean, cruelty-free, eco-friendly products, and discover beauty products on social media, Facebook and LINE.	Strong fit with the target customer; influencer marketing is essential.
Technological	E-commerce on Shopee and Lazada has grown quickly; data tools allow personalized marketing.	Launch online first and use customer data to refine campaigns.
Legal	Cosmetics need safety approval, ingredient disclosure and clear labeling; Thai rules align with international standards.	Budget for Thai FDA compliance and certifications such as cruelty-free and organic.
Environmental	Consumers and regulators expect recyclable packaging and responsible sourcing.	Sustainability is a selling point, but it must be real, not just a claim.

2.2 SWOT Analysis

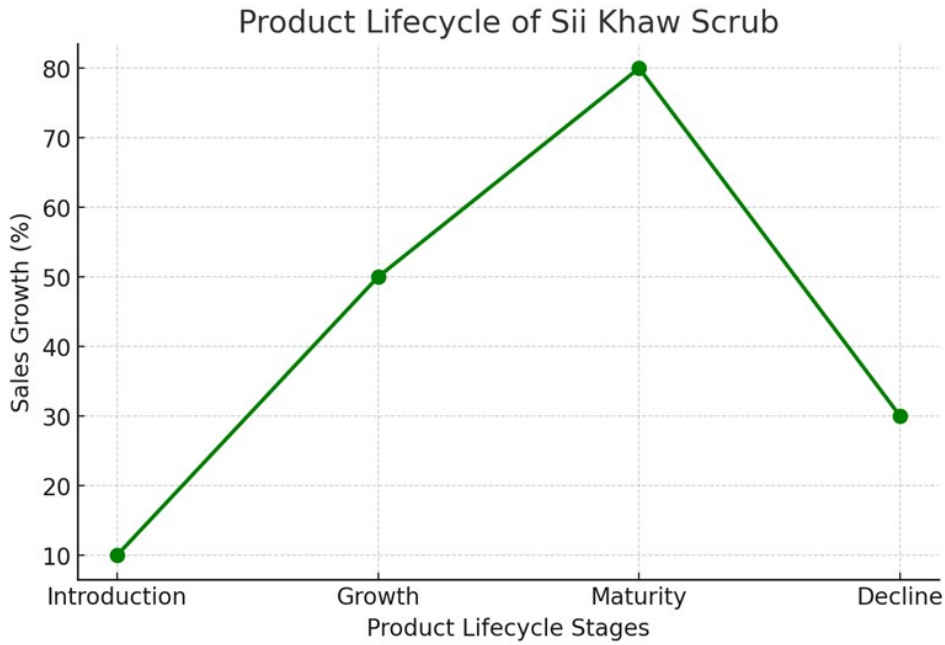
	Helpful	Harmful
Internal	**Strengths:** natural, antioxidant-rich tea formula; exfoliation plus hydration; recyclable packaging; access to quality ingredients in Chiang Rai	**Weaknesses:** a new, unknown brand; heavy marketing investment needed; ingredient costs vary with the seasons; little awareness outside Thailand
External	**Opportunities:** global clean-beauty demand; online and international sales; influencer partnerships; new lines such as face masks and body oils; regional market access	**Threats:** established competitors with big budgets; cheaper alternatives; different regulations by country; supply-chain disruptions; fast-changing trends



SWOT analysis of Sii Khaw scrub

2.3 Product Life Cycle

Stage	Sales	Marketing focus
Introduction	Slow	Build awareness and educate buyers about tea-based exfoliation through digital channels and influencers.
Growth	Rising	Expand to boutiques and eco-stores; add loyalty and referral programs; extend regional distribution.
Maturity	Peak	Keep customers engaged with limited-edition scents, bundles and seasonal offers; enter new markets.
Decline	Slowing	Reformulate, offer refills, or launch complementary products to renew demand.



Illustrative product life cycle of Sii Khaw scrub

2.4 Competitive Review

Brand	Signature product	Strength	Weakness	Sii Khaw's advantage
Herbivore Botanicals	Coco Rose Body Scrub	Natural, vegan, attractive packaging	High price	Similar natural focus at a lower price
St. Ives	Fresh Skin Apricot Scrub	Cheap and widely available	Walnut shell can be harsh and cause micro-tears	Gentle tea exfoliation that does not damage skin
Frank Body	Original Coffee Scrub	Strong social media brand among young buyers	Messy to use; coffee scent not for everyone	Cleaner, spa-like use with a calming tea scent

Takeaway: Sii Khaw sits in an open space between these brands: *gentle and natural like Herbivore*, *affordable like St. Ives*, *and social-media friendly like Frank Body*, with a Thai-heritage story none of them has.



Sii Khaw's competitive edge

2.5 Customer Persona and Journey

Persona: Maya, 20, skincare blogger in Bangkok.

- **Who she is:** part of Thailand's growing middle class; active on Instagram, TikTok and YouTube, where she reviews products and shares routines.
- **What she values:** natural ingredients such as green tea and botanicals, cruelty-free formulas, sustainable packaging, and brands that are honest about sourcing.
- **How she buys:** influenced by social media and brand transparency; willing to pay more for products that work and are ethical.
- **Why she matters:** as an influencer, she can bring her followers to the brand.



Persona profile of Maya, a skincare blogger

Early-adopter journey:

1. **Discover:** sees an influencer post about a natural, eco-friendly tea scrub.
2. **Consider:** checks ingredients, packaging and reviews on social media and wellness forums.
3. **Buy:** orders online, often trying a single pack first.
4. **Use:** enjoys gentle exfoliation and a spa-like experience at home.
5. **Advocate:** shares her experience and refers friends, creating word-of-mouth.

3. Marketing Strategy

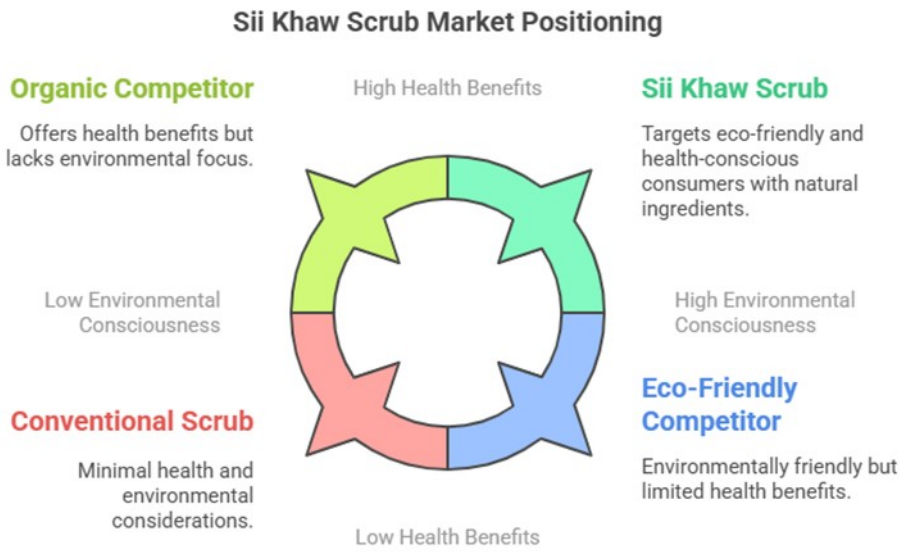
Sii Khaw competes on remarkability, not price: a gentle tea-based scrub that hydrates, smells calming and comes in recyclable packaging, sold at a fair price.

3.1 Positioning: the “Purple Cow” strategy

Following Seth Godin’s *Purple Cow* idea, Sii Khaw stands out by being remarkable on points competitors do not combine:

- **Tea-based exfoliation:** antioxidant-rich tea, honey, natural sugar and mineral salts instead of harsh or plastic exfoliants.
- **Two benefits in one:** exfoliation plus hydration from natural oils.
- **A spa-like moment:** a light, earthy tea scent that turns a routine into relaxation.
- **Sustainability:** organic ingredients and 100% recyclable packaging.

Positioning statement: *For health- and eco-conscious consumers who want effective but gentle skincare, Sii Khaw is the natural tea scrub that delivers a spa-like experience at an accessible price.*

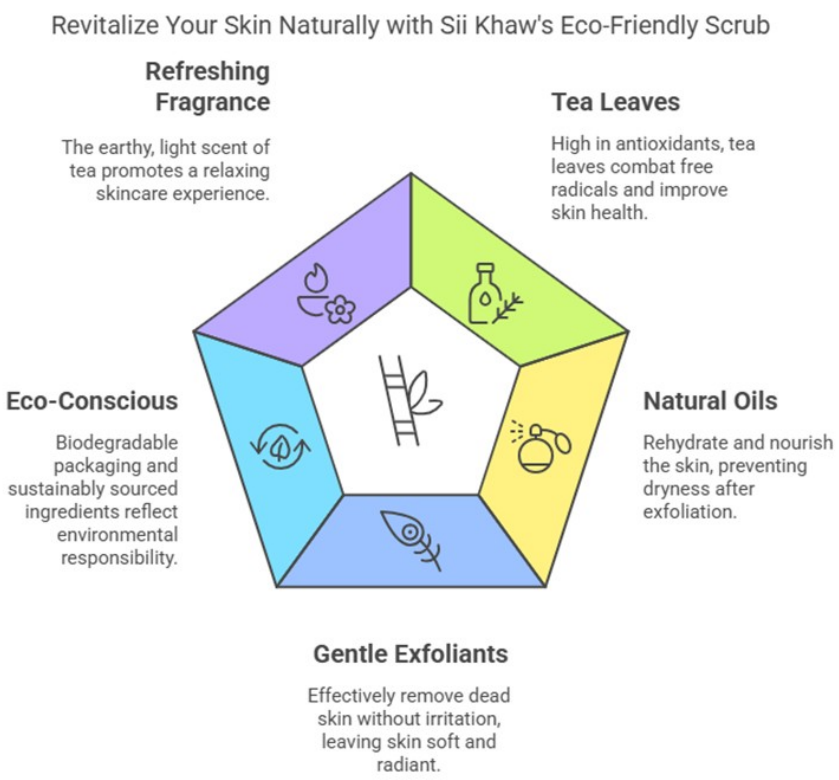


Market positioning map

3.2 Product

Ingredient	Benefit
Finely ground tea leaves	Antioxidants that fight free radicals and reduce dullness
Natural oils	Deep hydration, so skin does not dry out after exfoliating
Gentle natural exfoliants	Remove dead skin without irritation

The formula is free from harsh chemicals and parabens, cruelty-free, and suitable for sensitive skin.



Sii Khaw product features

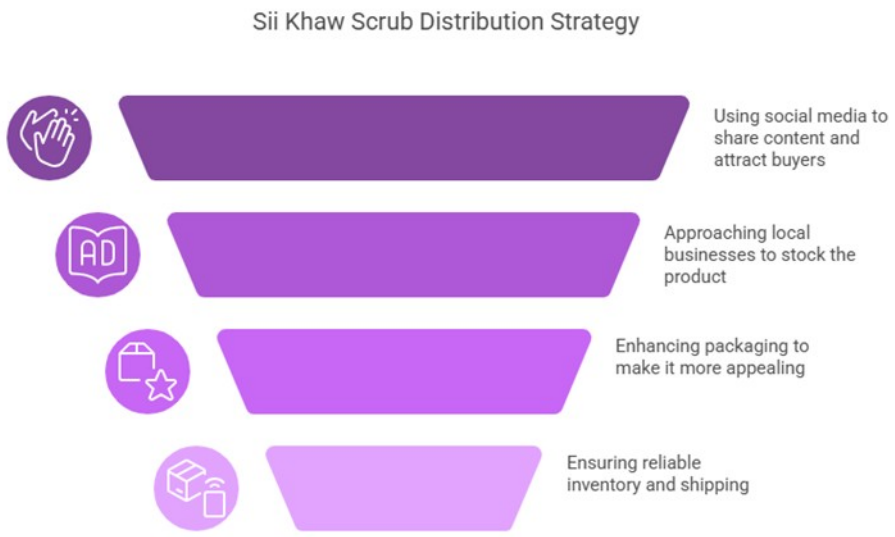
3.3 Price

We chose **value-based pricing**: prices reflect what customers get (natural tea extracts, local Thai herbs, gentle exfoliation) rather than cost plus a markup.

Package	Contents	Price	Best for
Single pack	300 ml	249 THB	First-time buyers trying the product
Bundle pack	3 × 300 ml	649 THB (save 13%)	Loyal customers who repurchase
Deluxe kit	Full-size jar + 100 ml travel size	749 THB	Gifts and travelers

3.4 Distribution

1. **Online first:** our own website plus marketplaces such as Shopee and Lazada, with social media driving traffic.
2. **Physical retail:** offer samples to local boutiques, beauty salons and eco-friendly stores to reach in-person shoppers.
3. **Reliable fulfilment:** steady inventory and dependable shipping partners for on-time delivery.



Sii Khaw distribution strategy

3.5 Branding

- **Name:** “Sii Khaw” comes from a Thai word meaning “whiteness”, suggesting purity.
- **Logo:** a scrub jar surrounded by green tea leaves, symbolizing health, freshness and calm.
- **Colors and style:** soft greens, white and earth tones; minimalist packaging with botanical patterns.
- **Voice:** knowledgeable but approachable, warm and encouraging.
- **Core message:** *“Natural beauty, sustainable care.”*

3.6 Promotion

Channel	Tactics
Social media	Instagram, TikTok and Facebook content calendars; hashtag campaigns; reposting customer reviews
Influencers	Tiered partners, from micro-influencers to wellness personalities, chosen for shared values
Content and email	Blog articles on skincare and sustainability for SEO; welcome series and personalized offers by email
In-store and events	Displays in eco-conscious stores; pop-up shops; skincare workshops with experts
Partnerships	Co-branded campaigns with environmental non-profits; limited-edition bundles with influencers

4. Launch Roadmap

The launch runs in four phases over two years, testing the market before spending on full expansion.

Phase	Timing	Goal	Key activities
1. Foundation	Months 1–3	Build the brand	Finalize formula and suppliers; launch website

Phase	Timing	Goal	Key activities
			and social media; plan content; secure first retail partners
2. Soft launch	Months 4–6	Validate the market	Test with real customers; start influencer collaborations; gather feedback and adjust positioning and prices
3. Full launch	Months 7–12	Grow sales	Campaigns across all channels; wider retail distribution; loyalty and referral programs; events
4. Expansion	Year 2	Go regional	Enter markets with strong natural-skincare demand; add complementary products; deepen community programs



Strategic roadmap

5. Conclusion

Sii Khaw meets a clear and growing need: natural, gentle and sustainable skincare at a fair price. The market analysis shows consumers moving toward clean beauty and a gap between expensive natural brands and harsh mass-market scrubs. By combining a remarkable tea-based product, value-based pricing, an online-first launch and community-driven promotion, Sii Khaw is well placed to build a loyal customer base in Thailand and expand across the region.

The main challenges are competition from established brands and the cost of building awareness. The phased roadmap manages these risks by validating demand before scaling.

References

1. Armstrong, G., & Kotler, P. (2017). *Marketing: An introduction* (13th ed.). Pearson.
2. Chaffey, D., & Ellis-Chadwick, F. (2019). *Digital marketing* (7th ed.). Pearson Education.
3. Godin, S. (2003). *Purple cow: Transform your business by being remarkable*. Portfolio.
4. Grant, R. M. (2021). *Contemporary strategy analysis* (11th ed.). Wiley.
5. Kotler, P., & Keller, K. L. (2016). *Marketing management* (15th ed.). Pearson Education.
6. Kotler, P., Kartajaya, H., & Setiawan, I. (2017). *Marketing 4.0: Moving from traditional to digital*. Wiley.
7. Ottman, J. A. (2017). *The new rules of green marketing*. Routledge.
8. Porter, M. E. (2008). The five competitive forces that shape strategy. *Harvard Business Review*, *86*(1), 78–93.
9. Solomon, M. R. (2019). *Consumer behavior: Buying, having, and being* (13th ed.). Pearson.
10. Thai Food and Drug Administration. (2023). *Cosmetic regulation and guidelines*. http://www.fda.moph.go.th
11. Company websites: Frank Body, Herbivore Botanicals and St. Ives (2023), for the competitive review.